



October Events at the Commons

OCT 19, 2:30-4:00pm

When Historians Say "Genocide": A Public History Roundtable

Public History Talks & Tours Series
Critical Humanities Commons



On two extraordinary occasions, Canadian historians urged the public to recognize atrocity — 1985, when it declared that the Holocaust had happened, and 2021, when it affirmed that Canada had a history of genocide. In this session, history professor Jordan Stanger-Ross, Coordinator of Public History at Uvic, presents a paper on these events, followed by responses from History colleagues Neilesh Bose, John Lutz, and Christine O'Bonsawin. In view of the present erosion of democratic norms, we ask whether and how historians should speak collectively to the public.

Public History is the practice of applying historical research and methods to an audience outside of the university. Museums, libraries, heritage sites all use history to make the past accessible and relevant for us. *Talks & Tours* is a speaker series offering scholars ways to deepen their engagement with Public History and learn from exceptional professionals and institutions.

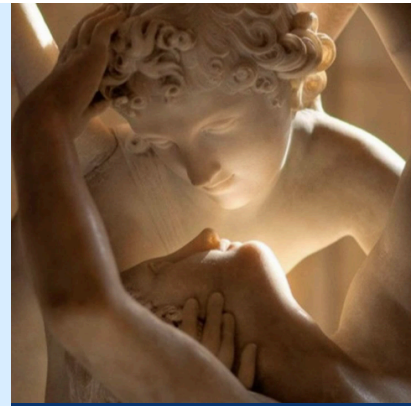
All are welcome to join, learn, and be inspired!

OCT 22, 4:00–6:00pm

Lost in Translation? Homer's *Odyssey* & Catullus in Love.

Commons Community

Critical Humanities Commons & Zoom



[Learn More](#)

The translation of Greek and Latin texts has become a subject of social and mainstream media discourse following the release of Christopher Nolan's film *The Odyssey*. In particular, Emily Wilson's translation of Homer's *Odyssey* has (re)emerged as a lightning rod for controversy. This interactive workshop will offer attendees an opportunity to compare select translations of Homer's *Odyssey* and Catullus' love poems and to consider the following questions: What are the purposes of translation? What factors shape different approaches to translation? How do translators make ancient texts accessible to a modern readership? What makes a translation successful?

This event is organized by the Department of Greek and Roman Studies.

OCT 27, 3:00–4:30

The Signals of Authoritarianism and Anti-Blackness in the Canadian Landscape by Rachel Zellars

Critical Encounters Speaker Series

Critical Humanities Commons & Zoom



[Learn More](#)

Rachel Zellars is a lawyer, Associate Professor, and Senior Research Fellow in the Department of Social Justice and Community Studies at Saint Mary's University. Prior, she served as a Postdoctoral Fellow at the University of Vermont in the Department of History, where her research focused on the history of Black migration and slavery in the Maritimes beginning in the 18th century.

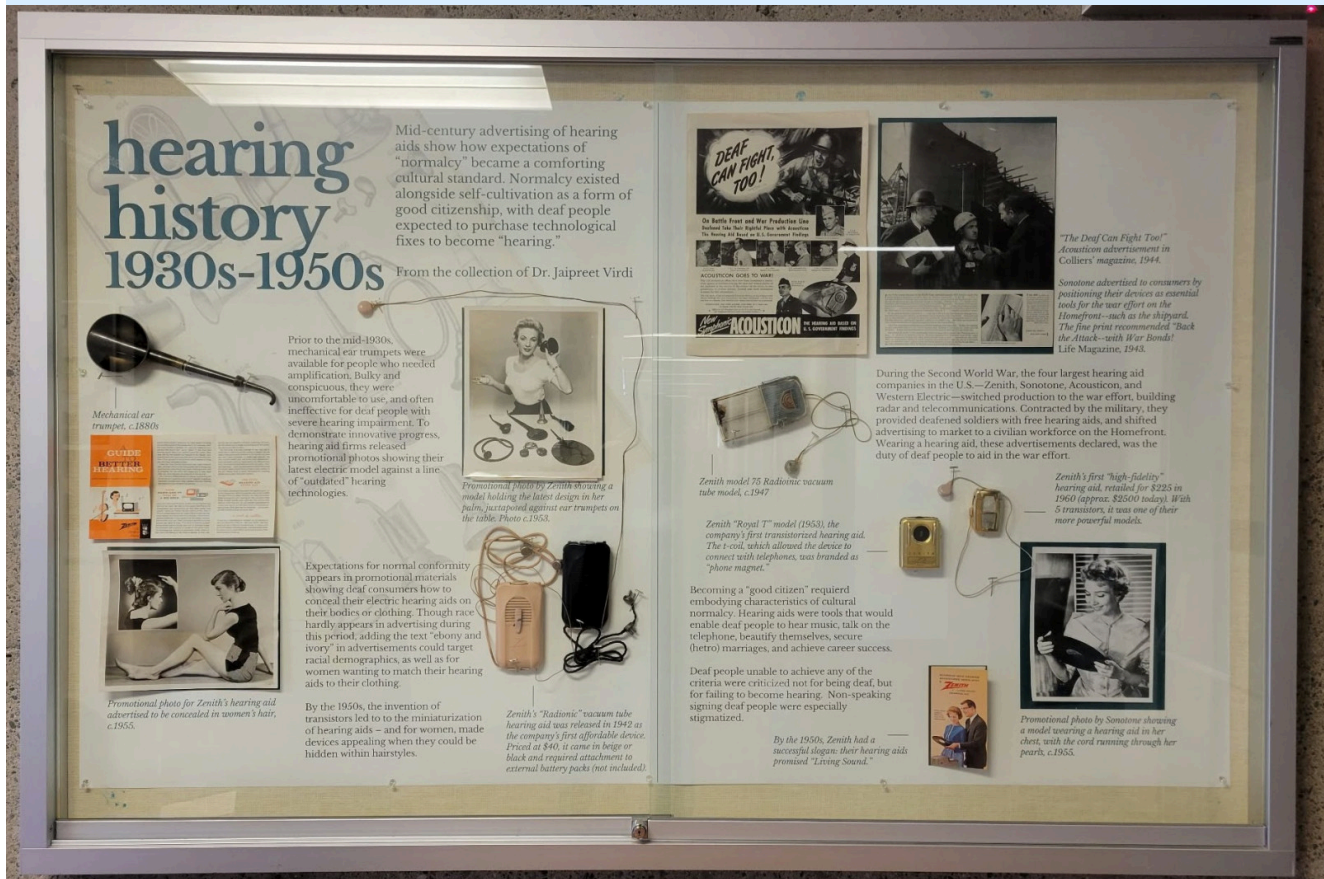
Dr. Zellars' research focuses on the histories of anti-black schooling segregation and resistance in Canada; migration and slavery in the Maritimes and throughout the Atlantic world from the 18th century; and the historical impact of gender violence in the lives of Black women.

NEW COMMONS EXHIBIT

Hearing History, 1930s-1950s

The Commons has a new exhibit curated by Dr. Jaipreet Virdi on the history of mid-20th century hearing aid advertising based on research for her first book *Hearing Happiness* (2020). Come check it out outside of Clearihue C305!

If you have an idea for an exhibit, please do get in touch with Dr. Virdi. We'd love to have a rotating exhibit for the year.



October Campus Events

OCT 1, 5:00-6:00pm

Religion and US Foreign Policy in an Age of Trump

**Centre for Studies in Religion and Society
MAC D282**



[Learn More](#)

OCT 2, 9:30am-3:30pm

CAPI Asia Forum

Centre for Asia-Pacific Initiatives
Upper Lounge SUB

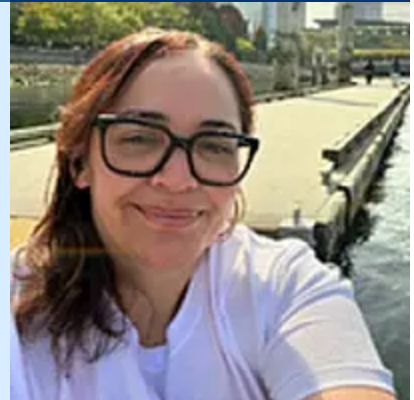
CAPI
ASIA
FORUM

[Learn More](#)

OCT 8, 11:00am-12:00pm

Te Ara Matihiko - Digital Futures: Building trust, codesign, and empowering whānau and Indigenous communities in a digital future

Centre for Asia-Pacific Initiatives
Engineering & Computer Science Building 660

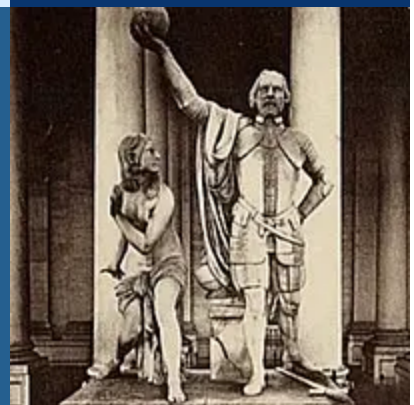


[Learn More](#)

OCT 7, 7:00pm

Café Historique: “October 12, 1492: Columbus “discovers” the “Indies” with Dr. Peter Cook

Department of History
Oak Bay Recreation Centre, 1975 Bee Street



[Learn More](#)

OCT 13, 7:30pm

Riverwork: Lisa Robertson (poet, essayist & novelist) in conversation with Rae Armantrout (poet)

The Orion Lecture Series in Fine Arts
Presented by the Department of Writing
Fine Arts Building, Room 103



[Learn More](#)

OCT 15, 4:30–6:00pm

The Right Against Rights in Latin America: A Latin American Studies Lansdowne Lecture by Dr. Leigh A. Payne

Centre for Global Studies
Fraser Building, Sky Classroom (B261)



[Learn More](#)

OCT 16, 9:30am–5:00pm

Human Rights, Memory & Democracy at a Crossroads: A Full-Day Symposium

Centre for Global Studies
Student Union Building, Upper Lounge

A FULL-DAY SYMPOSIUM

**Human Rights,
Memory &
Democracy**
at a Crossroads

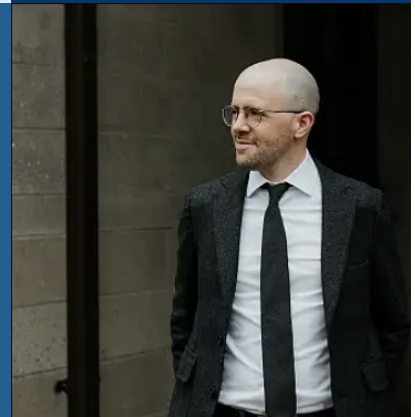
Part 1
Day 1
Lansdowne
Dr. Leigh A. Payne
October 16
Sky Classroom

[Learn More](#)

OCT 18, 3:00–4:00pm

2026 Lipson Lecture: The AI Alignment Problem

Faculty of Science
Farquhar Auditorium, JCC B115

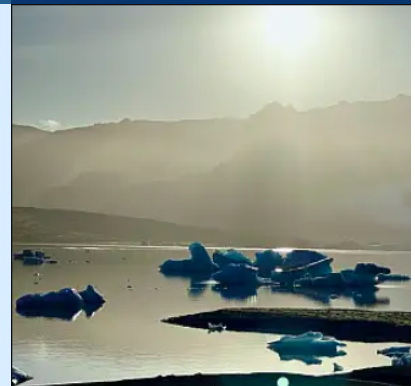


[Learn More](#)

OCT 25, 2:00pm

The Beck Lectures: Filming showing and Discussion--*A Fire to Last Until Morning: Why Make Art in the Climate Crisis?*

School of Languages, Linguistics, and Cultures
Clearihue A207



[Learn More](#)

OCT 29, 5:30pm

Sociology Lansdowne Lecture: Cecilia Menjívar

Sociology

Engineering and Computer Science 123



[Learn More](#)

We acknowledge and respect the Lək'wəḡən (Songhees and Xwsepsəm/Esquimalt) Peoples on whose territory the university stands, and the Lək'wəḡən and W̱SÁNEĆ Peoples whose historical relationships with the land continue to this day.

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